DAVID RIPLEY

GRC/SOC ANALYST | SECURITY ENGINEER

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README.MD

Computer Science major concentrating in cybersecurity with practical experience triaging alerts, investigating phishing activity, supporting security operations, and applying security frameworks. Blends technical skills with a collaborative mindset built through club leadership and CTF competitions. Ready to contribute as an entry-level analyst or engineer.

TECHNOLOGY

Software: Microsoft Defender, Splunk, knowbe4 PhishER, Burp Suite, Sentinel, Docker, Office365 Suite, Excel, Gemini AI, Claude, Tenable, Windows, Fedora Linux, Ubuntu Linux, Kali Linux, Jira, ServiceNow

WORK EXPERIENCE

Governance, Risk, and Compliance (GRC) Analyst

Georgia Tech Research Institute | Atlanta, GA | May 2026 – Present

- Assisted Cybersecurity Maturity Model Certification (CMMC) level 2 verification and evidence review process
- Audited and reviewed policy and firewall rule deviations requests
- Provided continuous support in protecting CUI and other sensitive data
- Created playbooks for MCP integration and ticket management

Threat Intelligence Intern

Cyber Security Forum Initiative | Washington, DC | Jun 2026 – Aug 2026

- Used frameworks like MITRE ATT&CK and the Cyber Kill Chain, to conduct adversary research on regional threat actors
- Produced clear and concise threat reports for both technical and non-technical stakeholders

Cyber Security Intel & Response Apprenticeship

Kennesaw State University | Kennesaw, GA | Sep 2025 – May 2026

- Investigated potential breaches using Microsoft Defender and Splunk
- Researched phishing attempts / created automated PhishER knowbe4 blocking rules
- Created dashboards (and workbooks) in both Splunk and Sentinel for easy to digest information
- Created and managed scans using Burp Suite Enterprise for continuous monitoring

Quality Assurance (QA) Tester

FIXD Automotive Inc. | Atlanta, GA | Jul 2024 – Mar 2025

- Created and maintained QA documentation and procedures
- Ran tolerance and response-time tests to validate performance specs
- Collaborated cross-functionally to ensure complete testing coverage

Bartender

The Select | Sandy Springs, GA | December 2021 – Mar 2026

- Worked in a high energy environment balancing customer experience, inventory management, and creating cocktails

EDUCATION

B.S. Computer Science
Kennesaw State University
Expected, May 2027,

- 3.18 GPA
- Cyber security club president
- Semester abroad, South Korea

CERTIFICATIONS

Comptia CySA+

- Fall 2025

Comptia Sec+

- Spring 2025

Google Cybersecurity Coursera

- Fall 2024

ACHIEVEMENTS

NCL Cybergames CTF

- Place 1st in the State of GA (2025)
- Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2025, Spring 2026, Fall 2026

Finalist for CyberStars at SecureWorld for Emerging Stars

- Fall 2025

“The Future of Digital Payments” Seminar Competition

- First Place Winner
- Spring 2025

Eagle Scout

- Boy Scouts of America
- Dec 2020